suggests Freed's ability to look over the Wall, and yet such a vantage is refused in favor of looking back at the western zone's shuttered spaces close to the border. An interpretive placard below reminds viewers of scenes along Bernauer Strasse, a street with houses that fell in both the western and the eastern sides of the city and thus was the site of numerous perilous escapes out of houses in the first days of the Wall. The middle distance here is accomplished with the placard, a reminder not just of the divided space but also of the passage of time, before and after the Wall, marked throughout the book.

Beyond the Wall and the divided city of Berlin, Freed's approaches to memory push the sense of division to other German sites in which layers of space and time continue to usher the past into the present. In one photograph (fig. 1.11), positioned at a dining room table, Freed sits across from a German antiwar activist in the Ruhr Valley. The table is covered with empty dishes, two half-empty cups of coffee, and crumpled napkins. The prongs of an angled fork point toward two propped-up photographs, each a formal portrait of a soldier. The men in the photographs appear to come from different eras, one from an earlier German or Prussian epoch and the other from a more recent time. A man in horn-rimmed glasses and a dark sweater is shown in a soft focus at the opposite end of the short table and looks down and to his side. The messy table is presented in contrast to the formal codes of the studio portraits that furnish the scene. Freed's direct view of the man and the photographs hints at complicity in this portrait; the lack of eye contact between the men also suggests strain. Like the image of the soldier by the Wall, Freed faces a subject while marking evidence of tension between them. The partially consumed cup of coffee directly in front of Freed's vantage suggests this encounter is still unfolding or paused for a moment. His subject faces obliquely toward Freed and away from his family photographs, which are propped up on the table and thus still appear to be the provenance of the man. The imperative to mourn victims of war becomes a matter of casual importance and is powerfully connected to the present. Nonetheless, the need to contend with the memory of Germany's fallen soldiers, for Freed and for his subjects, remains a complicated task.

In another photograph, Freed stands behind a short, stone wall, looking out on the road below, as an older man and woman walk from a parked car and up toward a cemetery (fig. 1.12). They wear long, dark overcoats and hats, and the woman tucks a bouquet of flowers under her left arm. Freed